

INTERNATIONAL news

China bans sale of US Micron chips alleging national security risk

The technology war between China and the US has reached a new level with China banning the sale of US chipmaker Micron Technology's products. Beijing claimed that the US memory chip manufacturer posed a national security risk, which is being refuted by the US Commerce Department as having "no basis in fact." The sale of Micron products in China contributed to nearly 11% of the company's total revenue of \$30.8 billion in 2022. The ban propelled a rally in Hong Kong tech stocks after witnessing a two-month low.

NVIDIA partners with MediaTek to deliver automotive solutions

In a recent update, MediaTek announced a partnership with NVIDIA to deliver a complete range of in-vehicle AI cabin solutions for the next generation of software-defined vehicles. The collaborating parties plan to combine the strengths of their automotive portfolios to provide solutions for state-of-the-art connected cars. As per the press release, MediaTek's smart cabin solutions will run NVIDIA DRIVE OS, DRIVE IX, CUDA, and TensorRT software technologies to deliver AI cabin and cockpit functions with cutting-edge graphics, AI, safety, and security features.

Nidec and Renesas join forces to develop next-gen E-Axle for EVs

A leading player in the field of automotive semiconductor solutions, Renesas recently announced its collaboration with Nidec Corporation to develop semiconductor solutions for a next-generation E-Axle (X-in-1 system) that integrates an EV drive motor and power electronics for electric vehicles (EVs). The partners plan to launch the first proof of concept (PoC) by the end of 2023, which will feature a 6-in-1 system with a DC-DC converter, OBC, and power distribution unit (PDU) as well as a motor, inverter, and gearbox. As per a jointly released statement, while Nidec plans to rapidly productise E-Axle systems and ramp up to mass production, Renesas plans to develop and deliver turnkey solutions for increasingly complex X-in-1 systems by expanding the jointly developed PoC for E-Axle reference designs.

tion objectives. The agreement was signed by V.V. Sivakumar, GM of NGEL, and Girish Ghildiyal, GM of HMEL, at Noida. As per the deal, both parties plan to join hands in the field of renewable energy by sourcing 250MW RE-RTC (round-the-clock) power to meet the requirement of HMEL and also exploring opportunities in the green hydrogen business and its derivatives like green ammonia and green methanol.

Tata Group subsidiary Agratas to set up EV battery plant in Gujarat

Recently, Tata Group subsidiary Agratas Energy Storage Solutions

Private Limited signed an agreement with the government of Gujarat to set up a gigafactory for lithium-ion batteries in Sanand. Being touted as India's first gigafactory for Li-ion batteries, Tata Group will initially invest ₹130 billion to have a manufacturing capacity of 20GW units. According to a joint statement from the parties, the capacity could be doubled in a second phase of expansion. It is noteworthy that Tata Motors already has an operational plant in Sanand. The company also acquired the adjoining Ford Motors' plant recently, and the process of integration of the two plants is underway. The MoU-signing ceremony was held in Gandhinagar

Quectel unveils advanced IoT factory and lays foundation for new innovation HQ

Quectel Wireless Solutions, a leading global IoT solutions provider, recently opened its new Global Intelligent Manufacturing Center (GIMC) in Changzhou. The company also announced



that it broke ground for its new innovation headquarters in Shanghai. The press release noted that its GIMC facility delivered advanced IoT automation and featured a manufacturing production line combining the latest tech like edge intelligence, machine learning, robotics, and machine vision solutions. As per the company, its factory will be capable of manufacturing 4G modules, 5G modules, smart modules, automotive grade modules, narrowband IoT modules, GNSS modules, Wi-Fi modules, and antennas.

Pylontech and Energy to jointly build a battery plant in Italy

Chinese lithium cell maker Pylon Technologies recently announced its plan to build its first overseas factory in Italy. This joint venture, called Pylon LiFeEU, will be co-owned by Pylontech EU, a company incorporated under Dutch law wholly owned by Pylontech, and Italian energy storage company, Energy. As per the press release, the factory will be based out of Energy's exist-

in the presence of Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel and officials from Tata Group.

Garuda and Naini to jointly manufacture drones in India

Chennai-based drone startup Garuda Aerospace recently entered into a joint development partnership with Naini Aerospace Engineering Limited (NAEL), a wholly owned subsidiary of HAL (Hindustan Aeronautics Limited) under the administrative control of the Ministry of Defence. Both parties will jointly manufacture advanced precision drones, which will be able to carry a payload of around 25kg. With this collabora-